

Singapore: National Day Rally 2026 - Families, technology, land potential

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- *The National Day Rally 2026 outlined initiatives to sustain trust, relevance, and resilience amid global uncertainties.*
- *Enhanced family policies form a multi-pronged package providing broader parental support.*
- *Foreign manpower will complement the local workforce in a careful and controlled way.*
- *Artificial intelligence remains central to Singapore's national agenda.*
- *Major projects to unlock land potential would support long-term construction growth.*

Sustaining trust, relevance, and resilience

Prime Minister (PM) Lawrence Wong's National Day Rally (NDR) 2026 speech on August 23 outlined key initiatives to ensure that Singapore remains trusted, relevant, and resilient, amid an increasingly turbulent global landscape. Beyond reaffirming Singapore's commitment to building trust and deepening global linkages, including through its role as ASEAN chair in 2027 and continued engagement with global partners including the US, we highlight three themes from NDR 2026: family support and openness, technology, and long-term development plans.

Family support and remaining open

Family support, a key pillar of the government's Forward Singapore agenda, was a major highlight of NDR 2026, and had been well flagged in the run-up. We view the first set of recommendations from the Marriage & Parenthood Reset Workgroup, announced by PM Wong, **as a multi-pronged package, which marks a step towards providing sustained support for parents across a child's crucial developmental years.**

The combination of increased childcare leave, stronger and more sustained financial support through the new SG Child Support Package, more affordable and accessible caregiving options, as well as improved access to housing for growing families (see *table* and [National Population and Talent Division's announcement](#)) addresses the key concerns identified by Singaporeans in a YouGov Survey conducted in July 2026 (see *chart*).

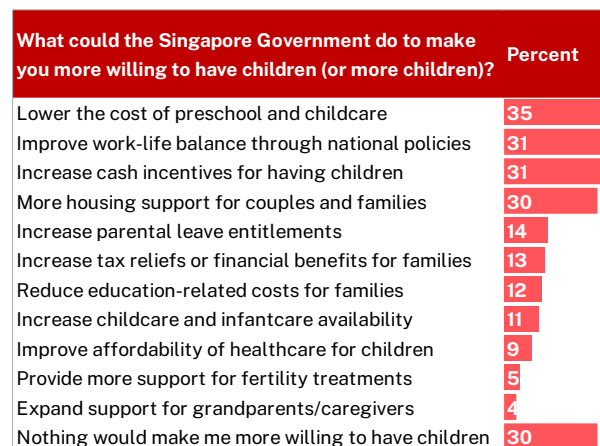
Supporting Families	
Policy Area	Key Measures
Childcare Leave	New streamlined childcare leave scheme for children aged 12 and below. Each working parent receives 8, 10, or 12 days annually depending on whether they have 1, 2, or 3+ children. Government to fully reimburse employers for all child-related leave schemes, up to the reimbursement cap.
SG Child Support Package	New package provides up to SGD62,000 per Singapore citizen child, regardless of birth order, comprising a SGD10,000 Baby Gift, SGD32,000 Child Credits over ages 1-16, SGD5,000 CDA First Step Grant, up to SGD5,000 CDA government co-matching, and a SGD10,000 PSEA top-up at age 17.
Support for Large Families	Additional assistance for families with three or more children, including studying enhanced support for healthcare, transport, and housing needs.
Affordable Preschool & Caregiving	Government-supported childcare and infant care fees to be reduced to SGD150 and SGD300 per month, respectively, by 2030. Full subsidies extended to all Singapore Citizen children regardless of parents' work status. Government-supported preschool operator network to be expanded.
Housing Support	From Feb 2027, first-timer families with or expecting children will receive one additional ballot chance per Singapore citizen child for BTO and SBF flat applications. BTO and EC income ceiling raised to SGD16,000 and SGD18,000, respectively.

Source: National Population and Talent Division, DBS compilation

These measures also built on earlier initiatives, such as parental leave enhancements, and support for large families announced during NDR 2024 and Budget 2025. While businesses may have concerns about operational challenges of expanded childcare leave provisions, they will have time to adjust given that implementations details are still forthcoming as feedback is being gathered on implementation. Businesses should view this as a strategic trade-off that supports the long-term sustainability of Singapore's demographic profile.

Even as Singapore aims to reverse its persistently declining fertility rate, which fell to a record low of 0.87 in 2025, PM Wong acknowledged that both the overall population and labour force will grow more slowly in the years ahead. To support economic growth, Singapore will continue to complement its Singaporean core by remaining open to foreign manpower in a

“careful and controlled” manner. PM Wong signalled that a modest easing of foreign worker policies, particularly for the services sector, is unlikely. Looking ahead, PM Wong said that Singapore's future economic growth should instead be driven more by technology and productivity gains.



Source: YouGov

Technology: navigating advancements

Technology, particularly artificial intelligence (AI), was a key theme for the second consecutive NDR, underscoring its growing importance within Singapore's national agenda. Critically, PM Wong reiterated that Singapore would embrace rapid technological advancements “on our own terms”, and provided a three-pronged approach to navigating the ongoing technological revolution: 1) seizing opportunities, 2) managing disruptions, and 3) putting safeguards in place.

Amid domestic labour and land constraints, we believe that harnessing technology and boosting productivity will be essential to sustaining healthy long-term economic growth, beside capital expansion through attracting foreign direct investments. PM Wong highlighted technological opportunities for small and medium-sized enterprises, as well as the healthcare, and transport sectors. At the same time, he highlighted that rapid technological

changes could create unforeseen disruptions and downside risks. These extend beyond jobs and include challenges arising from social media and digital platforms, which Singapore will need to carefully manage through appropriate safeguards.

Future development plans despite land constraints

Multi-decade development planning remains a defining feature of the NDR, with PM Wong unveiling further details on how Singapore intends to unlock additional land potential, despite the constraints of a small island nation. These reflect Singapore's core ability of strategising for the long haul, supported by a forward-looking policy mindset and ongoing political stability.

The three broad development possibilities and opportunities outlined by PM Wong, centred on looking beyond Singapore's main island to outer islands, could help to sustain what we believe is a multi-year construction boom. Major initiatives include the creation of a new western industrial island, the rejuvenation of Sentosa and Pulau Brani, further reclamation at Pulau Tekong, and new transport links.

First, the merging of several southern islands into a new Western island would support both defence requirements and future industries, including advanced manufacturing and new power generation infrastructure, as Singapore aims to sustain its key industrial base, and strengthen long-term energy security.

Second, the upcoming rejuvenation of Sentosa and Pulau Brani, part of the transformation of the southern waterfront, aims to enhance leisure and tourism offerings for both residents and international visitors. Third, Pulau Tekong, Singapore's largest outlying island, will undergo further reclamation along its southern coast. After accounting for defence priorities, around 500 hectares (around the size of Toa Payoh town) would eventually be made available for civilian use. Lastly, PM Wong reaffirmed Long Island as part of Singapore's multi-decade development agenda, partly in tackling climate change challenges.

These plans are expected to be supported by increased transport connectivity, such as innovative solutions like undersea tunnels. **Taken together, the reclamation projects and resulting infrastructure pipeline would provide some long-term visibility for construction growth, given Singapore's strong track record of executing major development plans.**

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Forecasts, data preview, central bank watch

21st August 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- BOK and BSP are set to hike rates, while BOT stays on an extended pause.
- Singapore's core and headline inflation are expected to tick up.
- Hong Kong export growth to moderate.



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The Week Ahead covers the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECASTS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Aug 25 (Tue)

Hong Kong: exports (Jun)	41.6% y/y	53.4% y/y
- imports	43.0% y/y	45.4% y/y
- trade balance	-HKD 55bn	-HKD 52bn
Taiwan: Industrial production (Jul)	20.7% y/y	23% y/y

Aug 26 (Wed)

Singapore: Industrial production (Jul)	9.0% y/y	7.2% y/y
Thailand: BOT Benchmark Interest Rate	1.00%	1.00%
US: GDP (second reading)	1.6% q/q saar	1.5% q/q saar

Aug 27 (Thu)

Philippines: BSP overnight borrowing rate	5.00%	4.75%
South Korea: BOK base rate	3.00%	2.75%

Aug 28 (Fri)

India: Industrial production (Jul)	5.2% y/y	7.3% y/y
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CENTRAL BANK MEETINGS

Bank of Thailand (BOT) (26 August)

We expect the BOT to maintain its policy rate at 1.00% at its August meeting, extending the pause following June's unanimous decision. Economic growth remains uneven, with both private consumption and foreign tourism weak but stabilising, while goods exports and private investment remain strong. Headline inflation, although elevated, has eased for three consecutive months, falling to 1.9% yoy in July from rates near the upper end of the BOT's 1-3% target range, largely due to lower energy prices. Given the uneven pace of economic growth and headline inflation remaining within the central bank's target range, the BOT retains scope to keep monetary policy unchanged and accommodative in order to support the economic recovery and complement fiscal policy amid ongoing geopolitical uncertainties.

Bank of Korea (27 August)

We expect the Bank of Korea to raise the base rate by a further 25bps to 3.00% at this meeting, alongside an upgrade to its annual macroeconomic forecasts. There is significant room for the BOK to revise up its 2026 GDP growth forecast to around 3.5%, from the current 2.6%, given the stronger-than-expected 1H growth of 3.8% yoy. There is also room to revise up its 2027 CPI inflation forecast to close to 3.0%, from the current 2.3%. Although headline CPI moderated slightly to 2.8% yoy in July, from 3.2% in June, core CPI continued to edge up to

2.6% from 2.5%, while housing prices also increased further, to 2.7% from 2.6%. These developments should keep the BOK cautious about the risk of inflation remaining above its 2% target for an extended period.

A hawkish hold at this meeting cannot be ruled out, however. This view mainly reflects the recent tightening in financial market conditions, driven by strong KRW appreciation and heightened KOSPI volatility. The BOK could therefore keep rates unchanged at this meeting while signalling the possibility of a further hike at the October meeting.

Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (27 August)

We expect the BSP to raise the benchmark rate by 25bp to 5%. Recent communication from the Governor has been focused on inflation risks, despite readings coming off recent highs (but remains way higher than target) and 2Q growth slowing sharply. Officials would likely prefer to see a more convincing disinflationary trend before drawing a pause. The currency's drift to record lows alongside a renewed rise in Brent prices adds to the case for a pre-emptive tightening response, with the call strengthened further by the moderation in the foreign reserves position. Beyond a likely hike in August, our baseline forecast is for one more hike within the year before slipping into a prolonged pause. Policymakers will monitor signs of a potential shift in the US Fed's policy bias as well as US yield movements in the near-term.

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

Hong Kong SAR

Exports growth is expected to moderate slightly from 53.4% yoy in June to 44.8% in July, largely reflecting base effects. The moderation is broadly in line with the easing in China's export growth, from 27.0% yoy in June to 23.9% in July. Nevertheless, trade momentum remains robust, supported by easing geopolitical disruptions following the Middle East ceasefire and strong demand for AI-related electronics. Import growth is also expected to remain firm, reflecting sustained demand for intermediate and capital goods amid resilient export orders and a gradual improvement in investment sentiment.

Singapore

We expect Singapore's headline and core inflation to rise to 2.4% yoy and 2.3% yoy, respectively, in July, from 1.9% yoy and 1.6% yoy in June. The pickup was due to the delayed pass-through of higher global energy costs reflected in the sharp 17% increase in electricity tariffs in 3Q26, alongside firmer food price increases. This build-up in underlying price pressures likely validated the central bank's decision to very slightly increase the appreciation pace of its currency policy band at its July review. Policymakers will likely maintain their vigilance and a slight hawkish stance toward upside inflation risks in their commentary on the inflation outlook,

given the ongoing disruptions and conflict in the Middle East.

We forecast industrial production growth to rise to 9.0% yoy in July, from 7.2% yoy in June. This was driven primarily by robust expansion in the electronics and precision engineering clusters, both of which continued to be underpinned by strong global demand for artificial intelligence-related hardware. However, factory performance remained uneven, as rising cost pressures and supply chain disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz continue to weigh on chemicals and general manufacturing clusters.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2024	2025	2026f	2027f	2024	2025	2026f	2027f
CHINA	5.0	5.0	4.5	4.3	0.2	0.0	1.0	1.0
HONG KONG	2.5	3.5	3.8	2.8	1.5	1.4	2.0	2.0
INDIA	6.7	7.8	6.8	6.4	4.9	2.2	4.5	4.2
INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) *	6.5	7.7	6.8	6.4	4.6	2.1	4.9	4.0
INDONESIA	5.0	5.1	5.3	5.1	2.3	1.9	3.3	2.2
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	5.2	4.5	1.8	1.4	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	5.6	4.5	4.7	5.0	3.2	1.7	6.5	4.0
SINGAPORE	5.3	5.0	5.0	3.0	2.4	0.9	2.2	2.0
SOUTH KOREA	2.0	1.0	3.5	2.4	2.3	2.1	2.6	2.1
TAIWAN	5.3	8.8	11.6	5.6	2.2	1.7	2.0	2.1
THAILAND	2.9	2.4	2.1	2.0	0.4	-0.1	1.7	1.0
VIETNAM	7.0	8.0	8.0	7.3	3.6	3.3	4.8	3.3
EUROZONE	0.7	1.5	1.0	1.2	2.3	2.2	3.1	2.1
JAPAN	0.1	1.2	0.9	1.0	2.7	3.2	1.8	1.5
UNITED STATES***	2.8	2.0	1.9	1.7	3.0	2.7	3.5	3.0

* 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation

POLICY INTEREST RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
CHINA*	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
INDIA	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
INDONESIA	4.75	5.75	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
SINGAPORE**	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.75	1.75	1.75
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75

* 1-yr Loan Prime Rate; ** 3M SORA OIS; *** refinancing rate; ^ deposit facility rate

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.75	6.70	6.74	6.78	6.81	6.85
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	93.4	93.9	94.4	95.0	95.5	96.1
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17760	17600	17660	17730	17790	17860
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.02	3.95	4.00	4.05	4.10	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	60.4	60.6	60.7	60.9	61.1	61.3
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.27	1.28	1.29	1.29	1.30
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1465	1450	1490	1505	1520	1535
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	32.7	32.0	32.5	33.0	33.5	34.0
USD/VND	26340	26310	26290	26290	26430	26570	26710	26850
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.70	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.69	0.69
EUR/USD	1.16	1.14	1.15	1.17	1.16	1.15	1.14	1.13
USD/JPY	159	163	156	151	153	154	155	157
GBP/USD	1.32	1.33	1.34	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2026				2027			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	3.68	3.75	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65
	2Y	3.79	4.16	3.85	3.85	3.90	3.95	3.95	3.95
	10Y	4.32	4.45	4.40	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.65
	10Y-2Y	52	29	55	65	65	65	70	70
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.27	1.41	1.50	1.60	1.75	1.85	1.85	1.85
	2Y	1.35	1.39	1.60	1.70	1.85	1.95	1.95	1.95
	10Y	2.35	2.72	2.80	2.85	2.95	3.00	3.00	3.00
	10Y-2Y	100	133	120	115	110	105	105	105
Eurozone	3M EURIBOR	2.08	2.32	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70
	2Y	2.62	2.53	2.55	2.60	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70
	10Y	3.00	2.86	3.10	3.20	3.25	3.30	3.30	3.30
	10Y-2Y	39	33	55	60	60	60	60	60
Indonesia	IDR 3M OIS	4.12	6.45	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90
	2Y	6.31	7.21	6.90	6.85	6.80	6.75	6.75	6.70
	10Y	6.86	7.16	7.00	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90
	10Y-2Y	55	-5	10	10	10	15	15	20
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.37	3.45	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.26	3.26	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.63	3.60	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.70	3.70
	10Y-3Y	37	35	40	40	40	40	45	45
Philippines	3M NDF implied yield	6.09	4.94	5.55	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05
	2Y	5.42	6.08	6.10	6.20	6.25	6.30	6.35	6.35
	10Y	6.98	6.90	7.65	7.75	7.80	7.85	7.90	7.95
	10Y-2Y	156	82	155	155	155	155	155	160
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	1.16	1.16	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
	2Y	1.61	1.58	1.55	1.60	1.62	1.65	1.67	1.70
	10Y	2.29	2.04	2.20	2.20	2.25	2.25	2.30	2.30
	10Y-2Y	68	45	65	60	63	60	63	60
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15
	2Y	1.41	1.14	1.35	1.35	1.45	1.50	1.50	1.50
	10Y	2.23	2.04	2.55	2.60	2.70	2.75	2.80	2.90
	10Y-2Y	82	90	120	125	125	125	130	140
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.37	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.86	1.73	1.75	1.80	1.80	1.85	1.85	1.85
	10Y-2Y	48	48	50	55	55	60	60	60
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	2.36	2.97	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
	2Y*	2.82	3.43	2.85	2.85	2.90	2.95	2.95	2.95
	10Y*	3.08	3.45	3.40	3.50	3.55	3.60	3.65	3.65
	10Y-2Y	26	2	55	65	65	65	70	70
Korea	3M CD	2.82	2.92	3.10	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20
	3Y	3.56	3.70	3.60	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75
	10Y	3.88	4.07	4.20	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25
	10Y-3Y	32	37	60	50	50	50	50	50
India	3M MIBOR	7.25	6.61	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75
	2Y	6.37	5.99	6.30	6.30	6.35	6.35	6.35	6.35
	10Y	7.04	6.75	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.85	6.85
	10Y-2Y	67	76	65	60	55	55	50	50

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps

Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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Thailand Chartbook: Middle East shock tests economy

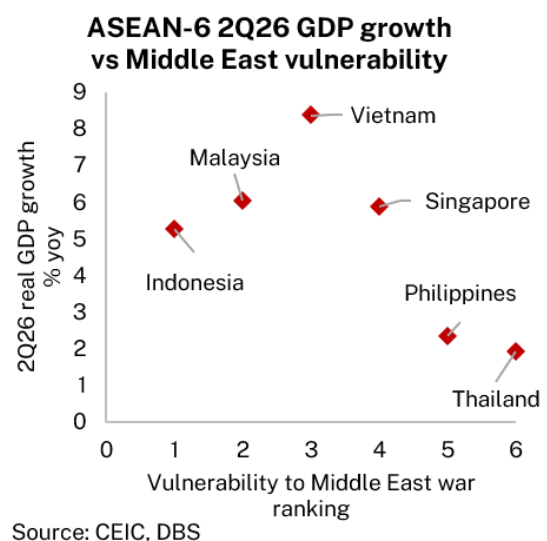
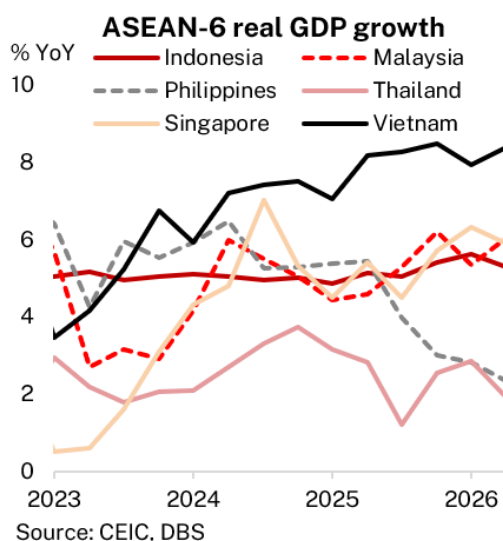
18 August 2026



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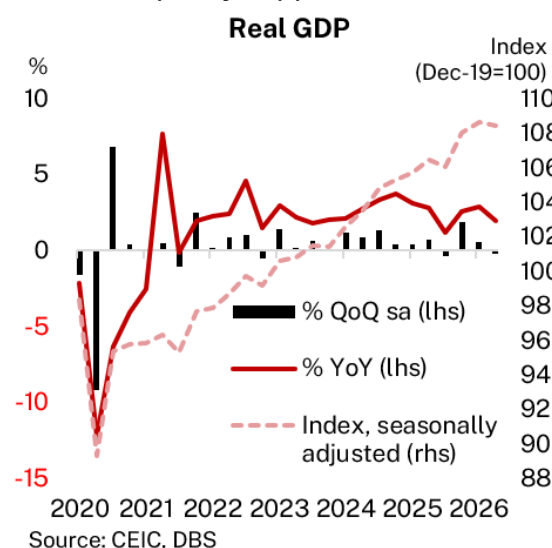
Violet Lee +65 68785281
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- Thai real GDP growth slowed to 1.9% yoy in 2Q26 from 2.8% yoy in 1Q26 due to headwinds from the Middle East shock.
- Private consumption would receive a temporary boost from government stimulus, after easing to its weakest pace since end-2021.
- Foreign tourism is soft despite July's rebound, with a sustained recovery dependent on the year-end seasonal demand.
- Goods exports and private investment continue to stand out as bright spots.
- External buffers are strong despite downward pressures.
- We continue to expect the BOT to keep its policy rate stable at 1.00% through the remainder of 2026.
- **Forecast implications:** We raise our 2026 GDP growth forecast to 2.1% (from 1.6%), and revise our 2026 headline inflation forecast to 1.7% (from 2.5%). These reflect the less severe-than-expected impact of the Middle East conflict and policy support amid ongoing challenges.

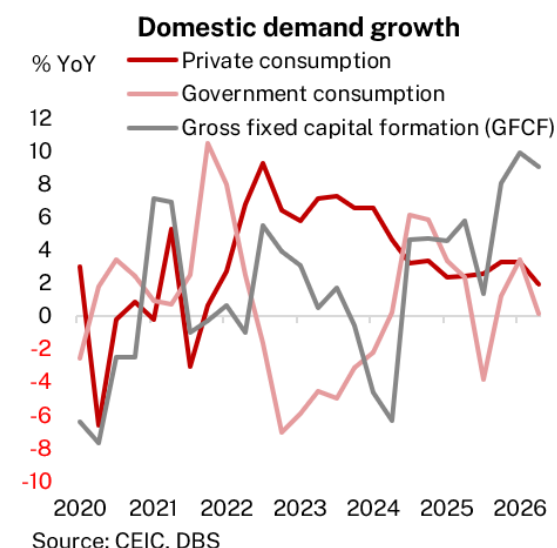


REAL GDP GROWTH

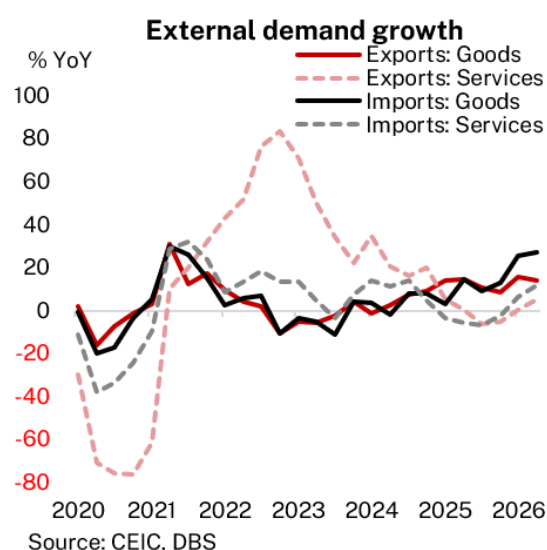
GDP growth slowed to 1.9% yoy in 2Q26 from a strong 2.8% yoy in 1Q, bringing 1H26 growth to 2.4% yoy. We raise our 2026 growth forecast to 2.1%, due to a less severe-than-expected Middle East shock and policy support.



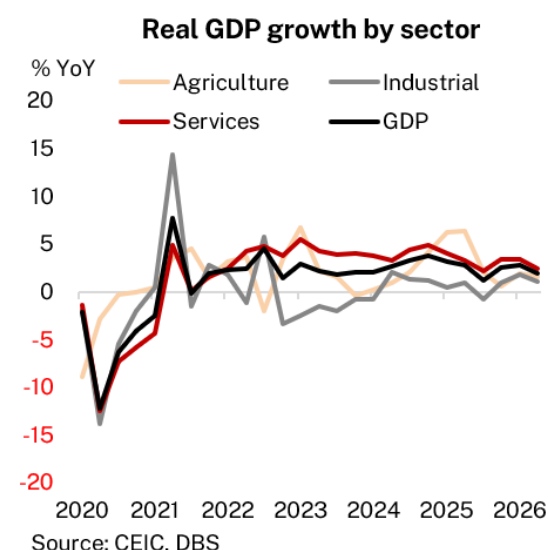
Overall economic weakness in 2Q26 was driven by slower private and government consumption growth, despite strong investment expansion. Private consumption growth eased to its lowest rate since the end of 2021.



Goods exports remained strong in 2Q26, supported by electronics shipments, but net trade contributed negatively to GDP due to robust imports, a trend that could persist in the near term.

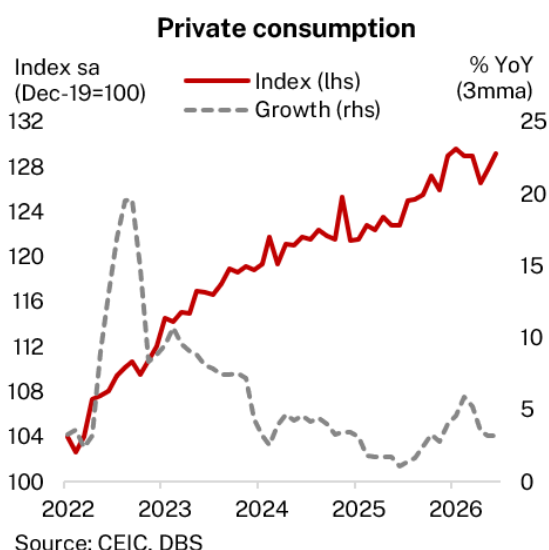


Growth momentum moderated across the agriculture, industrial, and services sectors in 2Q26. The slowdown in services was the most pronounced, reflecting weaker tourism-related and wholesale & retail trade activities.

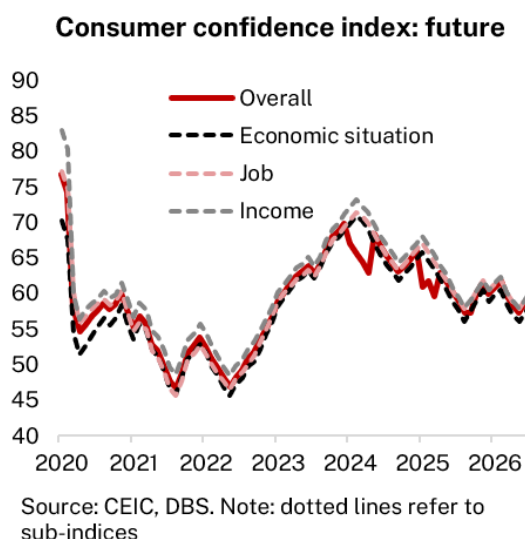


PRIVATE CONSUMPTION AND TOURISM

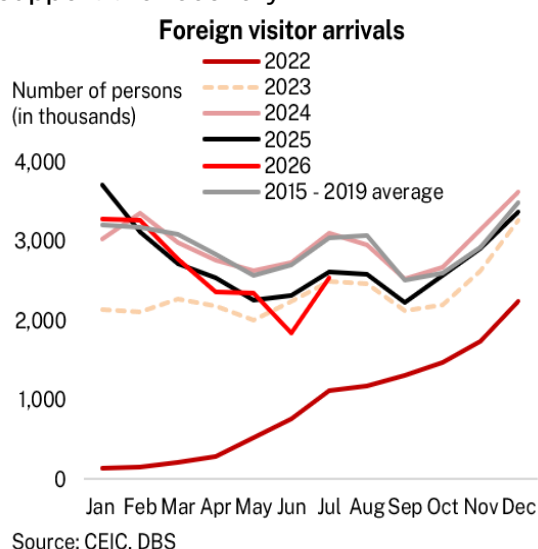
Private consumption, while facing challenges from the high cost of living and weaker consumer confidence stemming from the conflict in the Middle East, could be supported by government stimulus introduced from June 2026.



Consumer confidence has reached a cyclical trough in June 2026, supported by the government's THB175bn co-payment scheme, after declining since March, due to higher energy prices and uncertainty from the Middle East.



Foreign tourism trended lower in 1H26 due to higher jet fuel prices and softer demand. While visitor arrivals rebounded in July, sustained momentum into the year-end peak season will be key to support the recovery.

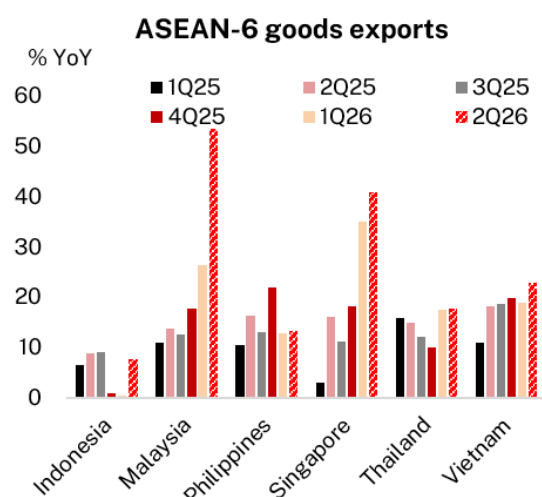


Despite geopolitical disruptions, long-haul arrivals from the Middle East and Europe remained resilient and have rebounded. However, visitors from China continued to be weak, holding back the overall tourism recovery.



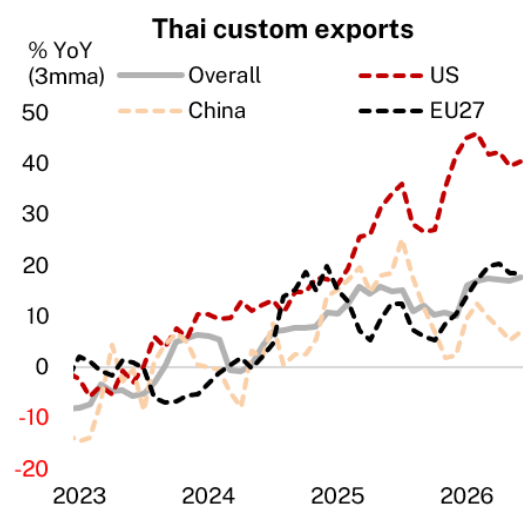
GOODS EXPORTS

Thailand's goods exports remain in solid shape and are providing strong support to the economy in 2026, although growth has been slower than in some regional peers, reflecting the extent of exposures to artificial intelligence (AI) demand.



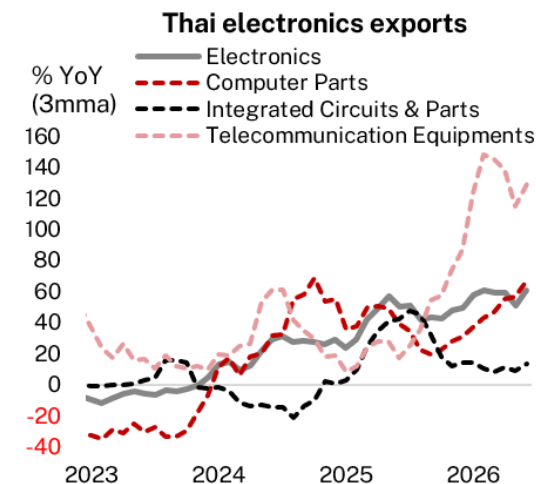
Source: CEIC, DBS. Note: % YoY in USD terms.

Thailand's strong exports performance has been notably supported by shipments to the US, despite America's increased protectionist stance.



Source: CEIC, DBS

Global AI tailwinds have lifted electronics exports across the region. Thai telecommunications equipment exports have been a key beneficiary, and will continue to benefit from strong investment by hyperscalers.

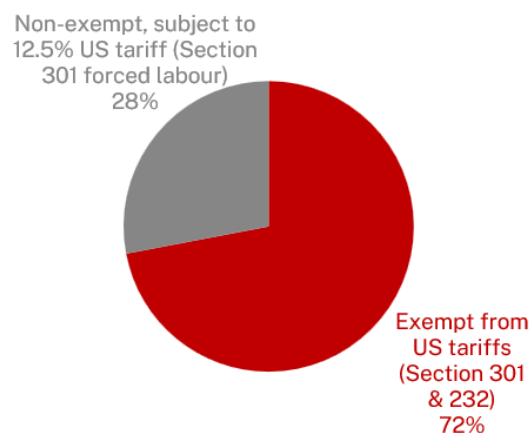


Source: CEIC, DBS

Note: dotted lines are selected sub-components

The direct impact of US tariffs on Thai goods exports to the US has been manageable thanks to significant exemptions. ~28% of Thai exports to the US will be subject to 12.5% US tariffs related to forced labour violations.

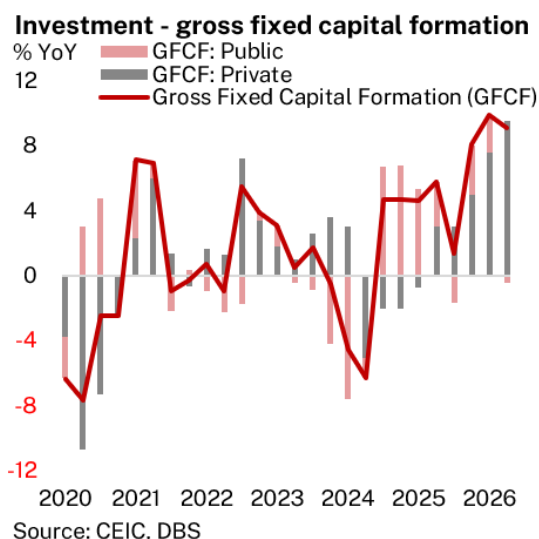
Thai exports to the US by tariff status



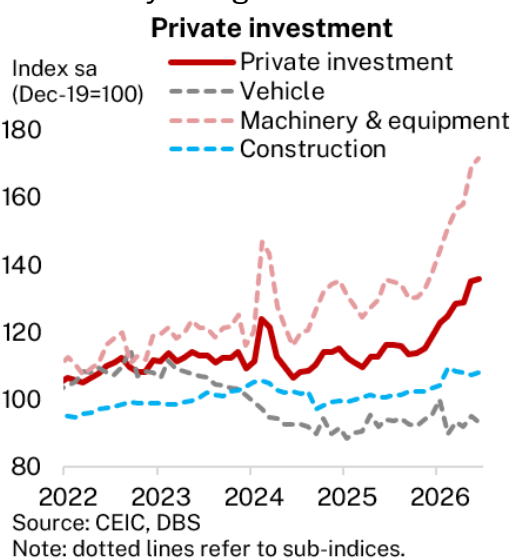
Source: Nation Thailand, DBS

INVESTMENT

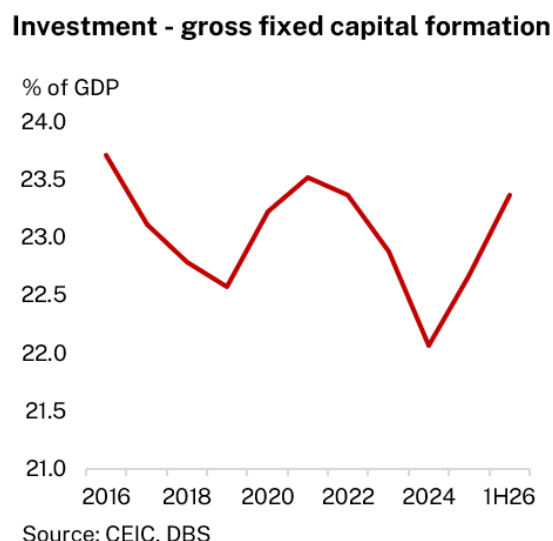
Thailand's investment upcycle remained intact in 2Q26, with growth sustaining strong momentum at close to its highest rate since 1Q15. Private investment continued to be the primary driver.



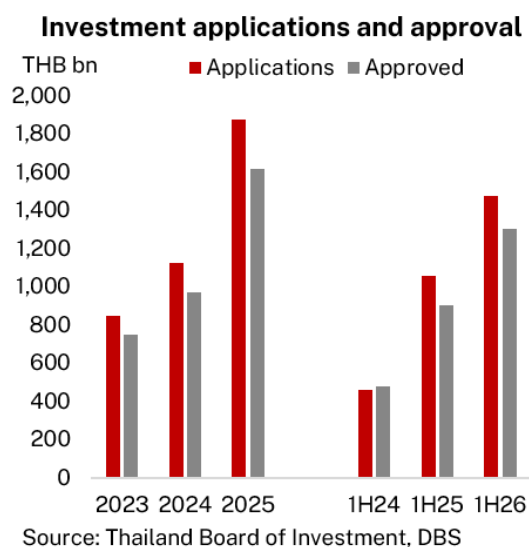
Private investment in 2026 has been driven by strong momentum in machinery and equipment spending, reflecting the realisation of investment applications and approvals, particularly those led by foreign investors.



The private investment upswing has lifted total investment as a share of GDP to its highest rate since 2022. The government aims to sustain the uptrend, although it remains to be seen if the 30% of GDP ambition can be achieved.

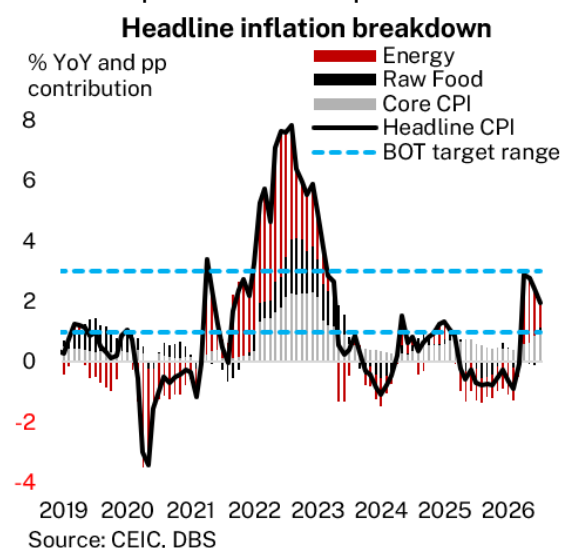


Investment applications and approvals accelerated in 1H26, pointing to a robust investment execution pipeline. These were supported by large digital infrastructure projects.

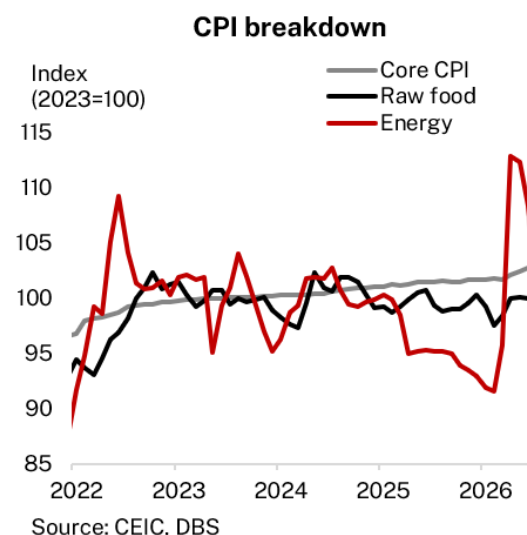


INFLATION AND MONETARY POLICY

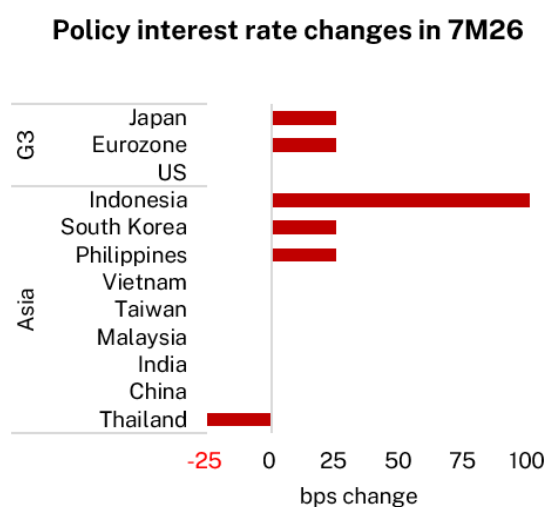
Headline inflation remains within the central bank's 1-3% target range despite the jump in April 2026, and has moderated since then. We revise our 2026 forecast to 1.7%, given the less severe impact than anticipated.



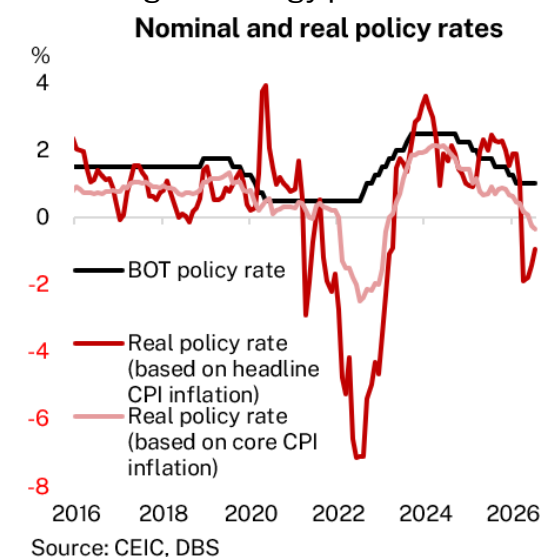
Fluctuations in headline CPI have mainly been driven by energy price volatility amid evolving tensions in the Middle East. Core and food inflation rates have risen but still look contained.



The Bank of Thailand (BOT) was the only central bank to cut its policy rate during the first seven months of 2026, seeking to support uneven economic growth, while looking through the temporary supply-driven inflation shock.



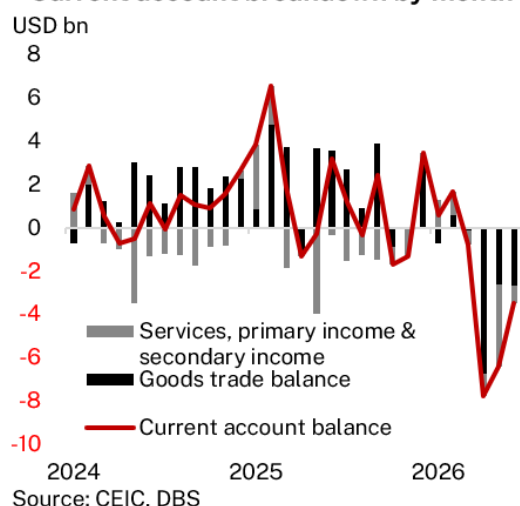
We think the BOT will have little urgency to adjust policy in the near term. The Middle East shock is weighing on growth and lifting inflation. The BOT will aim to support growth, as it expects inflation to ease alongside energy prices.



EXTERNAL POSITION

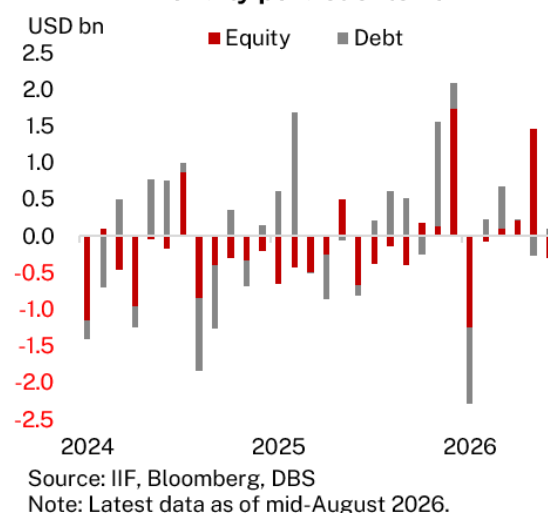
Thailand's current account has been in deficit since March 2026. Imports surged due to higher energy prices stemming from the war in the Middle East, alongside strong investment. These trends would persist in the near term.

Current account breakdown by month



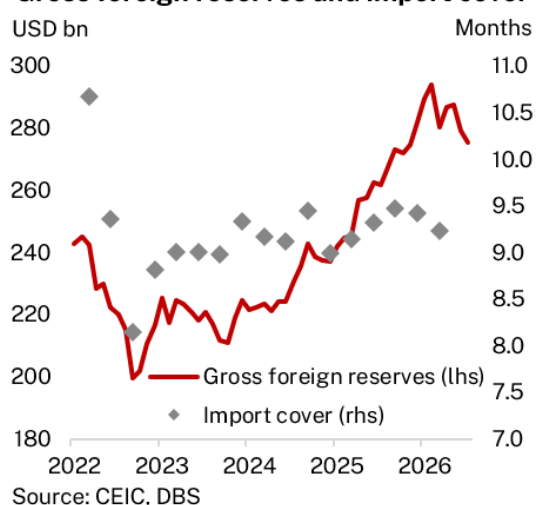
Portfolio flows have been supportive, despite increased volatility in 2026. Both equity and debt flows have benefitted from improved domestic politics, and less severe impact of the Middle East conflict, notwithstanding challenges.

Monthly portfolio flows



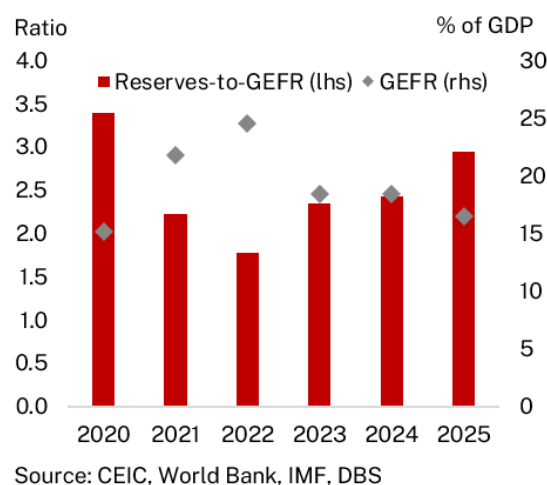
External buffers remain strong, with foreign reserves sufficient to cover around nine months of imports. This resilience is despite the recent surge in imports and pullback in international reserves.

Gross foreign reserves and import cover



The ratio of foreign reserves to gross external financing requirements should remain comfortable, although it will fall due to rising current account pressures. This could resemble the experience in 2022 when oil prices spiked.

Reserves and external financing needs



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Forecasts, data preview, central bank watch

14 August 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- *BI and PBOC to hold.*
- *A string of July trade data to show sustained external demand.*
- *Japan 2Q GDP and CPI print should support BoJ tightening.*



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The Week Ahead covers the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECASTS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Event	DBS	Previous
Aug 17 (Mon)		
China: retail sales (Jul)	0.4% y/y	1.0% y/y
- industrial production	5.4% y/y	5.3% y/y
- Fixed asset investment	-6.0% y/y	-5.7% y/y
Japan: GDP (2Q)	0.8% saar	1.8% saar
Malaysia: CPI (Jul)	1.9% y/y	1.9% y/y
Singapore: non-oil domestic exports (Jul)	26.5% y/y	20.7% y/y
Thailand: GDP (2Q)	1.9% y/y	2.8% y/y
Aug 19 (Wed)		
Indonesia: BI rate	5.75%	5.75%
Aug 20 (Thu)		
China: 1-year loan prime rate	3.00%	3.00%
Hong Kong: CPI (Jul)	2.0% y/y	2.0% y/y
Malaysia: exports (Jul)	40.0% y/y	45.4% y/y
- imports	40.3% y/y	43.9% y/y
- trade balance	MYR20.3bn	MYR14.9bn
Taiwan: export orders (Jul)	56.6% y/y	59.4% y/y
Japan: exports (Jul)	20.1% y/y	19.3% y/y
- imports	25.7% y/y	25.4% y/y
- trade balance	-JPY719.7bn	-JPY409.9bn
Aug 21 (Fri)		
Japan: CPI (Jul)	2.0% y/y	1.7% y/y

CENTRAL BANK MEETINGS

Bank Indonesia (BI) (19 August)

We expect Bank Indonesia to leave the BI rate at 5.75% in its August meeting. This meeting carries added significance as it will be chaired by acting Governor Destry Damayanti, after Perry Warjiyo resigned last month. President Prabowo has since nominated Deputy Governor Destry as the sole candidate for the position of the next Governor. If confirmed, the appointment will underscore the government's preference for a technocratic and market-oriented leadership transition, placing a seasoned BI official at the helm of the institution. The August rate review will provide a glimpse into the new leader's priorities and communication style.

July inflation had slowed to 2.9% yoy from 3.3% in June, while the 2Q growth was relatively resilient at 5.3%, with domestic drivers in the lead, especially investment, followed by consumption, while net trade was a drag. A firm 2Q growth report and stability in the rupiah makes the case for the BI to maintain its rates this month.

People Bank of China (PBOC) (20 August)

We expect the PBOC to keep the 1Y LPR unchanged next week, as resilient exports and stable industrial activity should continue to support growth momentum. Industrial production is expected to edge up from 5.3% yoy in June to 5.4% in July, supported by firm external demand. Exports stayed strong, rising 23.9% yoy in July, driven by the regional AI-electronics upcycle, while the hi-tech and equipment manufacturing sub-PMIs stayed in expansionary territory.

Domestic momentum, however, remains uneven. Retail sales growth is expected to moderate to 0.4% yoy in July, partly reflecting a high base from earlier trade-in subsidies. Household sentiment is weak amid uncertain job prospects, slower income growth and elevated precautionary savings, while subdued property prices continue to weigh on household wealth and consumption. Investment also stays weak, with fixed asset investment expected to contract further by 6.0% yoy ytd in July. Corporate investment is cautious amid the anti-involution campaign, while the property sector continues to be a major drag. Against this backdrop, policymakers are likely to maintain a measured policy stance, relying on targeted fiscal support to sustain growth rather than further rate cuts.

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

Hong Kong SAR

Headline CPI is expected to remain at 2.0% yoy in July, with elevated energy prices offset by the subdued goods and food prices. Electricity fuel charges and petrol prices increased in July, adding to utilities and transport costs, while housing inflation should edge higher amid a firmer residential rental market. However, subdued durable goods and food prices, alongside a slowdown in mainland tourist arrivals from 10.4% yoy in June to 2.7% in July, should partly offset these upward pressures.

Japan

2Q GDP, July trade, and CPI data are forthcoming. GDP growth is expected to post an on-trend rate of 0.8% QoQ saar, albeit lower than the 1.8% recorded in 1Q. Growth is expected to be largely driven by domestic demand. Consumption indicators appeared to have strengthened in 2Q, supported by decent wage increases and energy subsidies aimed at containing inflation. In contrast, exports in real terms have yet to show a substantial recovery in 2Q.

July trade data are expected to show export value growth picking up further to 20% yoy. CPI inflation, meanwhile, is expected to rise to 2.0% yoy in July from 1.7% in June. These readings would be consistent with the preliminary trade data for the first 20 days of July and the Tokyo CPI data released earlier. Overall,

the data will likely strengthen the case for an early rate hike by the Bank of Japan at its September meeting. However, an actual move would still hinge on market dynamics, including USD/JPY movements and the outcome of the September FOMC meeting.

Malaysia

We expect Malaysia's goods exports to expand by a strong 40.0% yoy in July 2026, extending the robust 45.4% yoy growth in June. Exports performance should remain underpinned by strong artificial intelligence demand for electrical & electronics products, alongside resilient oil and gas shipments, supported by energy prices amid evolving tensions in Middle East. We see Malaysia's headline inflation holding at 1.9% yoy in July 2026, stable relative to June. Price pressures should remain in check, as higher fuel inflation and energy cost pass-through were mitigated by fiscal subsidies.

Singapore

We forecast Singapore's non-oil domestic exports to rise by 26.5% yoy in July. The expansion should continue to be led by electronics shipments, supported by robust AI-related demand for memory chips and server-related products. Non-electronics exports may have rebounded due to favourable base effects, although petrochemicals shipments remained weak due to disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz.

Taiwan

July export orders are expected to moderate slightly to 56.6% yoy, from 59.4% in June. Earlier-released export data showed growth decelerating to 32.9% in July, the lowest reading in five months. In real terms, export growth slowed more notably to 13.1%. This reinforces our view that AI-driven super growth has peaked and is transitioning toward more normal growth in 2H. We expect a similar trend to be reflected in export orders.

Thailand

We expect Thailand's real GDP growth to decelerate to 1.9% yoy in 2Q26 from a strong 2.8% yoy in 1Q26. This slowdown reflected softer private consumption and weaker foreign tourist arrivals, due to challenges arising from the conflict in the Middle East. Government spending and robust private investment provided support, alongside strong goods exports expansion driven by global artificial intelligence tailwinds. However, robust goods imports momentum likely resulted in a negative net trade contribution in 2Q26.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2024	2025	2026f	2027f	2024	2025	2026f	2027f
CHINA	5.0	5.0	4.5	4.3	0.2	0.0	1.2	1.0
HONG KONG	2.5	3.5	3.8	2.8	1.5	1.4	2.0	2.0
INDIA	6.7	7.8	6.8	6.4	4.9	2.2	4.5	4.2
INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) *	6.5	7.7	6.8	6.4	4.6	2.1	4.9	4.0
INDONESIA	5.0	5.1	5.3	5.1	2.3	1.9	3.3	2.2
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	5.2	4.5	1.8	1.4	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	5.6	4.5	4.7	5.0	3.2	1.7	6.5	4.0
SINGAPORE	5.3	5.0	5.0	3.0	2.4	0.9	2.2	2.0
SOUTH KOREA	2.0	1.0	3.5	2.4	2.3	2.1	2.6	2.1
TAIWAN	5.3	8.8	9.4	4.5	2.2	1.7	2.0	2.1
THAILAND	2.9	2.4	1.6	2.0	0.4	-0.1	2.5	1.5
VIETNAM	7.0	8.0	8.0	7.3	3.6	3.3	4.8	3.3
EUROZONE	0.7	1.5	1.0	1.2	2.3	2.2	3.1	2.1
JAPAN	-0.2	1.2	0.5	0.5	2.7	3.2	1.8	1.8
UNITED STATES***	2.8	2.0	1.9	1.7	3.0	2.7	3.5	3.0

* 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation

POLICY INTEREST RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
CHINA*	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
INDIA	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
INDONESIA	4.75	5.75	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
SINGAPORE**	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.50	1.50
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75

* 1-yr Loan Prime Rate; ** 3M SORA OIS; *** refinancing rate; ^ deposit facility rate

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.75	6.70	6.74	6.78	6.81	6.85
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	93.4	93.9	94.4	95.0	95.5	96.1
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17760	17600	17660	17730	17790	17860
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.02	3.95	4.00	4.05	4.10	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	60.4	60.6	60.7	60.9	61.1	61.3
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.27	1.28	1.29	1.29	1.30
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1465	1450	1490	1505	1520	1535
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	32.7	32.0	32.5	33.0	33.5	34.0
USD/VND	26340	26310	26290	26290	26430	26570	26710	26850
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.70	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.69	0.69
EUR/USD	1.16	1.14	1.15	1.17	1.16	1.15	1.14	1.13
USD/JPY	159	163	156	151	153	154	155	157
GBP/USD	1.32	1.33	1.34	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2026				2027			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	3.68	3.75	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65
	2Y	3.79	4.16	3.85	3.85	3.90	3.95	3.95	3.95
	10Y	4.32	4.45	4.40	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.65
	10Y-2Y	52	29	55	65	65	65	70	70
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.27	1.41	1.45	1.50	1.55	1.75	1.75	1.75
	2Y	1.35	1.39	1.55	1.70	1.80	1.90	1.90	1.90
	10Y	2.35	2.72	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.75	2.75
	10Y-2Y	100	133	110	100	90	80	85	85
Eurozone	3M EURIBOR	2.08	2.32	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70
	2Y	2.62	2.53	2.55	2.60	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70
	10Y	3.00	2.86	3.10	3.20	3.25	3.30	3.30	3.30
	10Y-2Y	39	33	55	60	60	60	60	60
Indonesia	IDR 3M OIS	4.12	6.45	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90
	2Y	6.31	7.21	6.90	6.85	6.80	6.75	6.75	6.70
	10Y	6.86	7.16	7.00	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90
	10Y-2Y	55	-5	10	10	10	15	15	20
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.37	3.45	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.26	3.26	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.63	3.60	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.70	3.70
	10Y-3Y	37	35	40	40	40	40	45	45
Philippines	3M NDF implied yield	6.09	4.94	5.55	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05
	2Y	5.42	6.08	6.10	6.20	6.25	6.30	6.35	6.35
	10Y	6.98	6.90	7.65	7.75	7.80	7.85	7.90	7.95
	10Y-2Y	156	82	155	155	155	155	155	160
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	1.16	1.16	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
	2Y	1.61	1.58	1.55	1.60	1.62	1.65	1.67	1.70
	10Y	2.29	2.04	2.20	2.20	2.25	2.25	2.30	2.30
	10Y-2Y	68	45	65	60	63	60	63	60
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15
	2Y	1.41	1.14	1.35	1.35	1.45	1.50	1.50	1.50
	10Y	2.23	2.04	2.55	2.60	2.70	2.75	2.80	2.90
	10Y-2Y	82	90	120	125	125	125	130	140
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.37	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.86	1.73	1.75	1.80	1.80	1.85	1.85	1.85
	10Y-2Y	48	48	50	55	55	60	60	60
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	2.36	2.97	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
	2Y*	2.82	3.43	2.85	2.85	2.90	2.95	2.95	2.95
	10Y*	3.08	3.45	3.40	3.50	3.55	3.60	3.65	3.65
	10Y-2Y	26	2	55	65	65	65	70	70
Korea	3M CD	2.82	2.92	3.10	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20
	3Y	3.56	3.70	3.60	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75
	10Y	3.88	4.07	4.20	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25
	10Y-3Y	32	37	60	50	50	50	50	50
India	3M MIBOR	7.25	6.61	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75
	2Y	6.37	5.99	6.30	6.30	6.35	6.35	6.35	6.35
	10Y	7.04	6.75	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.85	6.85
	10Y-2Y	67	76	65	60	55	55	50	50

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps

Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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Forecasts, data preview, central bank watch

7th August 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- Singapore's final 2Q26 GDP likely to be revised up.
- India's July inflation is likely to hold steady at 4.4% yoy.
- China's credit demand is expected to stay weak, with mid- to long-term lending softening.



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The Week Ahead covers the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECASTS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Event	DBS	Previous
Aug 10 (Mon)		
China: new Yuan loan (Jul)	RMB10.8bn	RMB10.7bn
- M2	8.0% y/y	8.0% y/y
Aug 11 (Tue)		
Singapore: GDP (2Q, F)	5.9% y/y	5.7% y/y
Malaysia: industrial production (Jun)	8.0% y/y	8.4% y/y
Aug 12 (Wed)		
India: CPI (Jul)	4.4% y/y	4.4% y/y
- exports	13.5% y/y	15.5% y/y
- imports	9.5% y/y	31.0% y/y
- trade balance	-USD29bn	-USD30.4bn
US: CPI (Jul)	3.4% y/y	3.5% y/y
Aug 14 (Fri)		
Taiwan: GDP (2Q P)	12.9% y/y	12.9% y/y
Malaysia: GDP (2Q, F)	5.8% y/y	5.8% y/y

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

India

Inflation and trade numbers are due in the second week of August. Headline inflation in July was largely steady at 4.4% yoy vs June. High frequency data on food staples point to a rise in pulses, sugar, milk and edible oils, while vegetables have stabilised. A catch-up in rainfall in July has helped boost sowing activity. Adjustments in domestic retail fuel products (non-subsidised LPG was up 10% yoy in Jul) are also likely to reflect in the utilities and fuel segments. Core readings, however, should be benign at sub-4% in July, helped also by moderation in precious metals in the period. Separately, trade numbers should see the resilience in exports outweighed by a higher import bill, keeping the trade balance in red to the tune of -\$29bn, close to -\$30bn in June.

China

Credit demand remains weak, with new yuan loan expected to stay at RMB10.8bn in July. Both corporate and household medium- to long-term lending likely softened amid cautious borrowing sentiment and continued mortgage prepayments. M2 growth is expected to remain at 8.0% yoy. Precautionary savings stayed elevated, while weak property prices continued to weigh on household wealth. The wide gap between M2 and M1 growth is expected to persist, reflecting subdued corporate investment and household consumption.

Singapore & Malaysia

We expect Singapore's final 2Q26 GDP print to be revised up to 5.9% yoy and 1.3% qoq sa, from the advance estimates of 5.7% yoy and 1.1% qoq sa. The modestly higher growth figures were driven by a firmer manufacturing outturn than initially reported, alongside a possible upward revision to services growth amid stronger expansion in trade-related services, as indicated by the robust pickup in re-exports in June. With 1H26 growth tracking well above trend, we see a high likelihood that the government will upgrade its official 2026 GDP growth forecast to 4.0-5.0% from 2.0-4.0%, even as it continues to flag high uncertainty and downside risks to the outlook.

Separately, Malaysia's final 2Q26 GDP release will confirm an acceleration in growth at 5+% yoy, supported by stronger exports expansion driven by global artificial intelligence-related tailwinds, as well as sustained domestic demand underpinned by resilient household spending and continued investment implementation.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2024	2025	2026f	2027f	2024	2025	2026f	2027f
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INDIA	6.7	7.8	6.8	6.4	4.9	2.2	4.5	4.2
INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) *	6.5	7.7	6.8	6.4	4.6	2.1	4.9	4.0
INDONESIA	5.0	5.1	5.3	5.1	2.3	1.9	3.3	2.2
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	5.2	4.5	1.8	1.4	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	5.6	4.5	4.7	5.0	3.2	1.7	6.5	4.0
SINGAPORE	5.3	5.0	4.3	3.0	2.4	0.9	2.2	2.0
SOUTH KOREA	2.0	1.0	3.5	2.4	2.3	2.1	2.6	2.1
TAIWAN	5.3	8.8	9.4	4.5	2.2	1.7	2.0	2.1
THAILAND	2.9	2.4	1.6	2.0	0.4	-0.1	2.5	1.5
VIETNAM	7.0	8.0	8.0	7.3	3.6	3.3	4.8	3.3
EUROZONE	0.7	1.5	1.0	1.2	2.3	2.2	3.1	2.1
JAPAN	-0.2	1.2	0.5	0.5	2.7	3.2	1.8	1.8
UNITED STATES***	2.8	2.0	1.9	1.7	3.0	2.7	3.5	3.0

* 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation

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MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
SINGAPORE**	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.50	1.50
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75

* 1-yr Loan Prime Rate; ** 3M SORA OIS; *** refinancing rate; ^ deposit facility rate

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.75	6.70	6.74	6.78	6.81	6.85
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	93.4	93.9	94.4	95.0	95.5	96.1
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17760	17600	17660	17730	17790	17860
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.02	3.95	4.00	4.05	4.10	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	60.4	60.6	60.7	60.9	61.1	61.3
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.27	1.28	1.29	1.29	1.30
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1465	1450	1490	1505	1520	1535
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	32.7	32.0	32.5	33.0	33.5	34.0
USD/VND	26340	26310	26290	26290	26430	26570	26710	26850
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.70	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.69	0.69
EUR/USD	1.16	1.14	1.15	1.17	1.16	1.15	1.14	1.13
USD/JPY	159	163	156	151	153	154	155	157
GBP/USD	1.32	1.33	1.34	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2026				2027			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	3.68	3.75	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65
	2Y	3.79	4.16	3.85	3.85	3.90	3.95	3.95	3.95
	10Y	4.32	4.45	4.40	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.65
	10Y-2Y	52	29	55	65	65	65	70	70
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.27	1.41	1.45	1.50	1.55	1.75	1.75	1.75
	2Y	1.35	1.39	1.55	1.70	1.80	1.90	1.90	1.90
	10Y	2.35	2.72	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.75	2.75
	10Y-2Y	100	133	110	100	90	80	85	85
Eurozone	3M EURIBOR	2.08	2.32	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70
	2Y	2.62	2.53	2.55	2.60	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70
	10Y	3.00	2.86	3.10	3.20	3.25	3.30	3.30	3.30
	10Y-2Y	39	33	55	60	60	60	60	60
Indonesia	IDR 3M OIS	4.12	6.45	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90
	2Y	6.31	7.21	6.90	6.85	6.80	6.75	6.75	6.70
	10Y	6.86	7.16	7.00	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90
	10Y-2Y	55	-5	10	10	10	15	15	20
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.37	3.45	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.26	3.26	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.63	3.60	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.70	3.70
	10Y-3Y	37	35	40	40	40	40	45	45
Philippines	3M NDF implied yield	6.09	4.94	5.55	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05
	2Y	5.42	6.08	6.10	6.20	6.25	6.30	6.35	6.35
	10Y	6.98	6.90	7.65	7.75	7.80	7.85	7.90	7.95
	10Y-2Y	156	82	155	155	155	155	155	160
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	1.16	1.16	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
	2Y	1.61	1.58	1.55	1.60	1.62	1.65	1.67	1.70
	10Y	2.29	2.04	2.20	2.20	2.25	2.25	2.30	2.30
	10Y-2Y	68	45	65	60	63	60	63	60
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15
	2Y	1.41	1.14	1.35	1.35	1.45	1.50	1.50	1.50
	10Y	2.23	2.04	2.55	2.60	2.70	2.75	2.80	2.90
	10Y-2Y	82	90	120	125	125	125	130	140
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.37	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.86	1.73	1.75	1.80	1.80	1.85	1.85	1.85
	10Y-2Y	48	48	50	55	55	60	60	60
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	2.36	2.97	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
	2Y*	2.82	3.43	2.85	2.85	2.90	2.95	2.95	2.95
	10Y*	3.08	3.45	3.40	3.50	3.55	3.60	3.65	3.65
	10Y-2Y	26	2	55	65	65	65	70	70
Korea	3M CD	2.82	2.92	3.10	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20
	3Y	3.56	3.70	3.60	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75
	10Y	3.88	4.07	4.20	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25
	10Y-3Y	32	37	60	50	50	50	50	50
India	3M MIBOR	7.25	6.61	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75
	2Y	6.37	5.99	6.30	6.30	6.35	6.35	6.35	6.35
	10Y	7.04	6.75	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.85	6.85
	10Y-2Y	67	76	65	60	55	55	50	50

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps

Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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Forecasts, data preview, central bank watch

July 31, 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- India is expected to keep the benchmark policy rate unchanged at 5.25%.
- Indonesia 2Q GDP growth is expected to moderate to 5.3% yoy.
- Philippines 2Q GDP growth is projected to show signs of bottoming out.



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The Week Ahead covers the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECASTS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Event	DBS	Previous
Aug 3 (Mon)		
Indonesia - CPI (Jul)	3.1% y/y	3.3% y/y
- exports (Jul)	0.3% y/y	-5.7% y/y
- imports	26.7% y/y	22.2% y/y
- trade balance	-USD1.0bn	-USD1.6bn
Vietnam: exports (Jul)	25.5% y/y	28.1% y/y
- imports	40.0% y/y	45.2% y/y
- trade balance	-USD2.8bn	-USD2.6bn
- retail sales YoY YTD (Jul)	13.5% y/y	12.9% y/y
- CPI (Jul)	5.0% y/y	4.7% y/y
Aug 4 (Tue)		
Hong Kong: retail sales (Jun)	8.5% y/y	7.9% y/y
South Korea: CPI (Jul)	3.3% y/y	3.2% y/y
Aug 5 (Wed)		
India: RBI repurchase rate	5.25%	5.25%
Indonesia: GDP (2Q)	5.3% y/y	5.6% y/y
Philippines: CPI (Jul)	6.5% y/y	6.4% y/y
Aug 6 (Thu)		
Taiwan: CPI (Jul)	2.5% y/y	2.6% y/y
Thailand: CPI (Jul)	3.0% y/y	2.4% y/y
Aug 7 (Fri)		
Philippines: GDP (2Q)	3.0% y/y	2.8% y/y
China: exports (Jul)	17.0% y/y	27.0% y/y
- imports	26.8% y/y	36.0% y/y
- trade balance	USD92.0bn	USD125.6bn
Taiwan: exports (Jul)	41.1% y/y	40.3% y/y
- imports	52.6% y/y	51.8% y/y
- trade balance	USD15.4bn	USD12.2bn

CENTRAL BANK MEETINGS

Reserve Bank of India policy committee (5 Aug)

The Reserve Bank of India monetary policy committee (MPC) is expected to keep the benchmark rate unchanged at 5.25% on 5 Aug. We anticipate a cautious policy statement, that underscores the need for continued vigilance on the inflation outlook, while placing greater emphasis on core inflation as a more reliable measure of underlying price pressures than headline inflation, which has been influenced by both domestic and global supply-side factors. Against this backdrop, the committee is likely to push back against market expectations of a more aggressive tightening path reflected in implied rates.

That said, the MPC is increasingly confronted by signs of a build-up in inflationary risks. Brent crude prices have risen amid renewed geopolitical tensions. Below-normal rainfall presents upside risks to food inflation, and the development of El Niño conditions could lead to higher imported agricultural commodity prices. Therefore, a more hawkish bias in policy guidance may become increasingly difficult to avoid as the real policy rate cushion narrows, inflation risks remain skewed to the upside, and the probability of GDP growth exceeding 7% in 1QFY27 increases.

For the path ahead, markets will be watchful of developments in West Asia

and signs of any change in the US Federal Reserve's policy outlook in the second half of 2026. These developments will have important implications for the rupee, capital flows, and interest rate differentials. In the near term, the anticipated recovery in portfolio inflows, together with continued inflows via the swap windows, should provide a constructive backdrop for onshore markets.

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

China

Exports growth is expected to moderate from 27.0% yoy in June to 17.0% in July, as renewed tensions in the Middle East weighed on external demand. High-frequency indicators suggest export momentum has eased, with total deadweight tonnage handled at China's 20 major ports slowing from 12.9% yoy in June to 12.1% in July. Meanwhile, international cargo flights declined 26.7% to an average of 9,468 per week in July, pointing to softer trade activity.

Hong Kong

Retail sales growth is expected to accelerate from 7.9% yoy in May to 8.5% in June, supported by resilient tourism activity and improving domestic consumption. Mainland visitor arrivals remained robust, growing 10.4% yoy in June. Meanwhile, the growth in residents' outbound departures eased from 8.1% yoy in May to 5.2% in June, suggesting fewer residents spending abroad and a

partial shift in consumption back to the domestic market.

South Korea

July inflation data are due for release. Headline CPI is expected to remain elevated at 3.3% yoy, up slightly from 3.2% in June and well above the Bank of Korea's 2% inflation target. The rebound in global oil prices, driven by renewed tensions in the Middle East, is likely to keep imported inflationary pressures elevated. Demand-side inflation remains relatively contained, reflecting the impact of the BOK's pre-emptive monetary tightening in anchoring inflation expectations. We expect CPI inflation to remain in the 3.0–3.5% yoy range throughout 2H26, which should prompt the BOK to deliver an additional 50bps of rate hikes, taking the policy rate to 3.25% by year-end.

Taiwan

July trade and inflation data are due for release. Export growth is expected to remain strong at around 40% yoy, resulting in a robust trade surplus of USD15bn. Excluding price effects, however, export growth is likely to have moderated to around 20% yoy. We maintain our view that the AI-driven export supercycle has peaked and is transitioning toward a more normalised growth trajectory.

CPI inflation is expected to remain elevated at 2.5% yoy. The rebound in oil prices amid renewed Middle East tensions is likely to keep imported raw material costs elevated, while the severe

typhoon in July is also expected to have pushed up fresh food prices. We continue to expect CPI inflation to remain in the 2.0–2.5% yoy range through 2H26, prompting the central bank to deliver a 12.5bps rate hike in 4Q26.

Indonesia and Philippines

Inflation and 2Q26 growth numbers are due in early-August. For Indonesia, we expect 2Q26 growth to moderate to 5.3% yoy from 1Q's 5.6%. Momentum at the beginning of the year was jumpstarted by religious festive spending and strong increase in public spending. Entering the second quarter, fiscal spending remained supportive, complemented by stimulus measures and the limited pass-through of elevated global energy prices to household consumption, as domestic fuel prices remained unchanged. Private sector business activity was likely impacted by Middle East hostilities, shifts in domestic policy architecture, and subdued trade sector performance.

Growth in Philippines is expected to show signs of bottoming out but remain at modest levels, with 2Q output set to register 3% yoy rise. Inflation outcomes will benefit from a temporary pullback in global energy prices, but food costs are set to turn dearer on El Nino risks in Philippines as well as Indonesia. BSP is expected to tighten policy rates, while BI will opt to keep rates on hold after back-to-back increases.

Thailand

We expect Thailand's headline inflation to accelerate to 3.0% yoy in July, the upper end of the central bank's 1-3% target range, from 2.4% yoy in June. The pickup reflected firmer food price increases amid low base effects, and higher core inflation due to the pass-through of energy costs. Energy-driven inflation likely remained elevated as global and domestic fuel prices rebounded following the escalation of tensions in the Middle East. Nonetheless, the Bank of Thailand is unlikely to rush into monetary tightening, as it looks through this supply-driven increase in inflation, balancing with concerns about uneven economic growth.

Vietnam

We expect Vietnam's goods exports to expand by 25.5% yoy in July, extending the strong growth of 28.1% yoy in June, supported by robust electronics shipments benefitting from spillovers from artificial intelligence-related demand, despite weakness in textiles, garments, and footwear exports. Retail sales likely picked up amid resilient domestic consumption and solid tourism arrivals, despite elevated inflation. We anticipate headline inflation to rise to 5.0% yoy in July from 4.7% yoy in June, driven by firmer transport price increases as global and domestic fuel prices rebounded following the escalation of tensions in the Middle East, alongside persistently elevated food inflation.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2024	2025	2026f	2027f	2024	2025	2026f	2027f
CHINA	5.0	5.0	4.5	4.0	0.2	0.0	1.2	1.5
HONG KONG	2.5	3.5	3.0	2.8	1.5	1.4	1.6	1.5
INDIA	6.7	7.8	6.8	6.4	4.9	2.2	4.5	4.2
INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) *	6.5	7.7	6.8	6.4	4.6	2.1	4.9	4.0
INDONESIA	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.1	2.3	1.9	3.6	2.2
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	5.2	4.5	1.8	1.4	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	5.6	4.5	4.7	5.0	3.2	1.7	6.5	4.0
SINGAPORE	5.3	5.0	4.3	3.0	2.4	0.9	2.2	2.0
SOUTH KOREA	2.0	1.0	3.5	2.4	2.3	2.1	2.6	2.1
TAIWAN	5.3	8.8	9.4	4.5	2.2	1.7	2.0	2.1
THAILAND	2.9	2.4	1.6	2.0	0.4	-0.1	2.5	1.5
VIETNAM	7.0	8.0	8.0	7.3	3.6	3.3	4.8	3.3
EUROZONE	0.7	1.5	1.0	1.2	2.3	2.2	3.1	2.1
JAPAN	-0.2	1.2	0.5	0.5	2.7	3.2	1.8	1.8
UNITED STATES***	2.8	2.0	1.9	1.7	3.0	2.7	3.5	3.0

* 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation

POLICY INTEREST RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
CHINA*	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
INDIA	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
INDONESIA	4.75	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.25
SINGAPORE**	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50	2.50
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.50	1.50
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75

* 1-yr Loan Prime Rate; ** 3M SORA OIS; *** refinancing rate; ^ deposit facility rate

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.75	6.70	6.74	6.78	6.81	6.85
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	93.4	93.9	94.4	95.0	95.5	96.1
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17760	17600	17660	17730	17790	17860
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.02	3.95	4.00	4.05	4.10	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	60.4	60.6	60.7	60.9	61.1	61.3
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.27	1.28	1.29	1.29	1.30
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1465	1450	1490	1505	1520	1535
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	32.7	32.0	32.5	33.0	33.5	34.0
USD/VND	26340	26310	26290	26290	26430	26570	26710	26850
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.70	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.69	0.69
EUR/USD	1.16	1.14	1.15	1.17	1.16	1.15	1.14	1.13
USD/JPY	159	163	156	151	153	154	155	157
GBP/USD	1.32	1.33	1.34	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2026				2027			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	3.68	3.75	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65
	2Y	3.79	4.16	3.85	3.85	3.90	3.95	3.95	3.95
	10Y	4.32	4.45	4.40	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.65
	10Y-2Y	52	29	55	65	65	65	70	70
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.27	1.41	1.45	1.50	1.55	1.75	1.75	1.75
	2Y	1.35	1.39	1.55	1.70	1.80	1.90	1.90	1.90
	10Y	2.35	2.72	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.75	2.75
	10Y-2Y	100	133	110	100	90	80	85	85
Eurozone	3M EURIBOR	2.08	2.32	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70
	2Y	2.62	2.53	2.55	2.60	2.65	2.70	2.70	2.70
	10Y	3.00	2.86	3.10	3.20	3.25	3.30	3.30	3.30
	10Y-2Y	39	33	55	60	60	60	60	60
Indonesia	IDR 3M OIS	4.12	6.45	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90
	2Y	6.31	7.21	6.90	6.85	6.80	6.75	6.75	6.70
	10Y	6.86	7.16	7.00	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90
	10Y-2Y	55	-5	10	10	10	15	15	20
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.37	3.45	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.26	3.26	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.63	3.60	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.70	3.70
	10Y-3Y	37	35	40	40	40	40	45	45
Philippines	3M NDF implied yield	6.09	4.94	5.55	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05
	2Y	5.42	6.08	6.10	6.20	6.25	6.30	6.35	6.35
	10Y	6.98	6.90	7.65	7.75	7.80	7.85	7.90	7.95
	10Y-2Y	156	82	155	155	155	155	155	160
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	1.16	1.16	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20
	2Y	1.61	1.58	1.55	1.60	1.62	1.65	1.67	1.70
	10Y	2.29	2.04	2.20	2.20	2.25	2.25	2.30	2.30
	10Y-2Y	68	45	65	60	63	60	63	60
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15
	2Y	1.41	1.14	1.35	1.35	1.45	1.50	1.50	1.50
	10Y	2.23	2.04	2.55	2.60	2.70	2.75	2.80	2.90
	10Y-2Y	82	90	120	125	125	125	130	140
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.37	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.86	1.73	1.75	1.80	1.80	1.85	1.85	1.85
	10Y-2Y	48	48	50	55	55	60	60	60
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	2.36	2.97	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
	2Y*	2.82	3.43	2.85	2.85	2.90	2.95	2.95	2.95
	10Y*	3.08	3.45	3.40	3.50	3.55	3.60	3.65	3.65
	10Y-2Y	26	2	55	65	65	65	70	70
Korea	3M CD	2.82	2.92	3.10	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20
	3Y	3.56	3.70	3.60	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75	3.75
	10Y	3.88	4.07	4.20	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25	4.25
	10Y-3Y	32	37	60	50	50	50	50	50
India	3M MIBOR	7.25	6.61	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75	6.75
	2Y	6.37	5.99	6.30	6.30	6.35	6.35	6.35	6.35
	10Y	7.04	6.75	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.85	6.85
	10Y-2Y	67	76	65	60	55	55	50	50

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps

Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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